CHAPTER 14

Quantitative data analysis

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

After completing Chapter 14 you should be able to:

1. Demonstrate the ability to get data ready for quantitative analysis.
2. Describe the various processes by which one can get a feel for the data in a study.
3. Describe the means by which the reliability and validity of measures can be assessed.

INTRODUCTION

After quantitative data have been collected from a representative sample of the population, the next step is to analyze them to answer our research questions. However, before we can start analyzing the data, some preliminary steps need to be completed. These help to ensure that the data are accurate, complete, and suitable for further analysis. This chapter addresses these preliminary steps in detail. Subsequently, general guidelines are provided for calculating and displaying basic descriptive statistics.

The easiest way to illustrate data analysis is through a case. We will therefore introduce the Excelsior Enterprises case first.